# Platform Setup & API Configuration Guide

Welcome to the platform! To get everything fully operational, you will need to configure a few external services. This guide will walk you through, step-by-step, on how to obtain the necessary API keys and credentials required to run the application securely and smoothly.

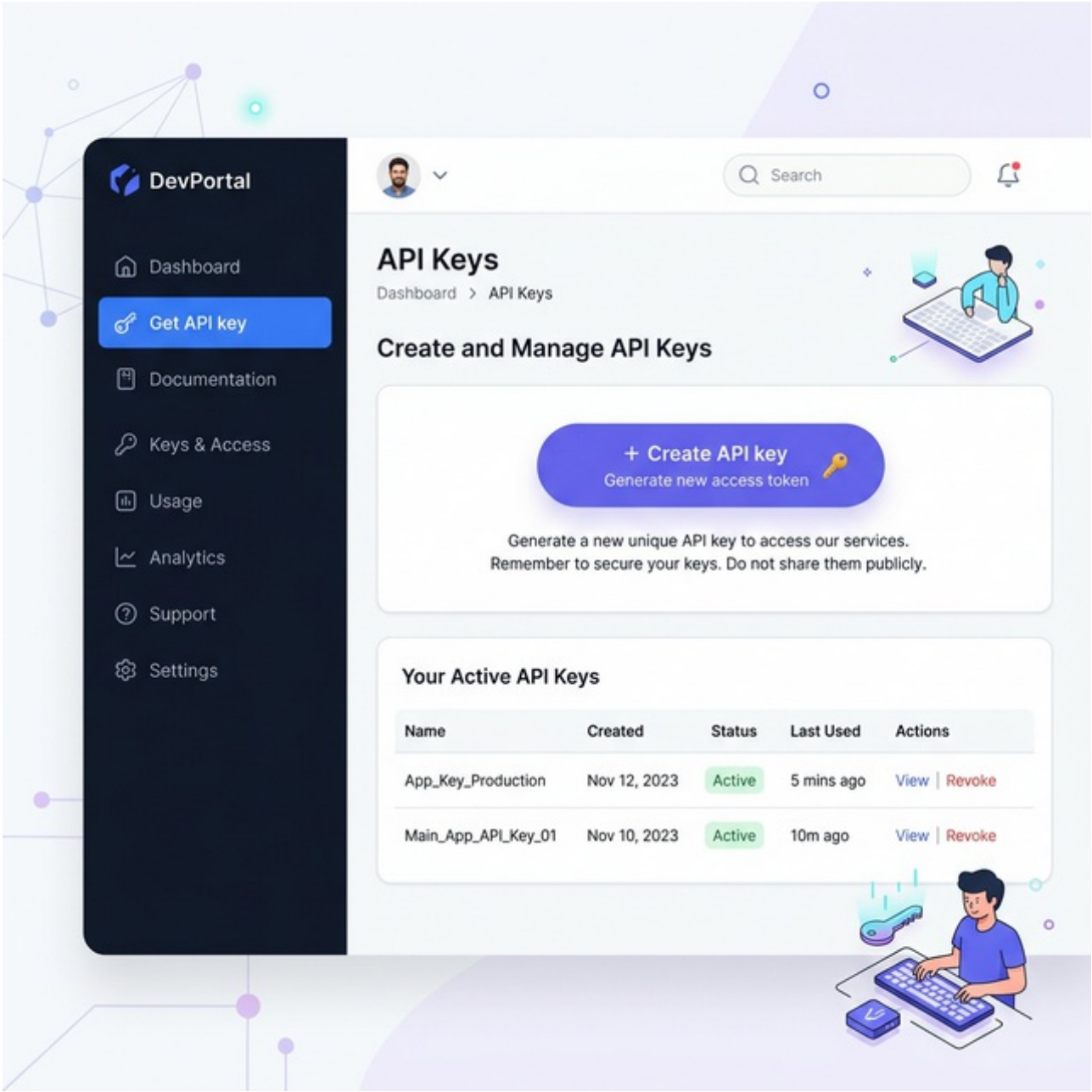
## 1. Google Gemini API (AI Content Generation)

Our platform utilizes Google's Gemini AI to automatically generate content and process data.

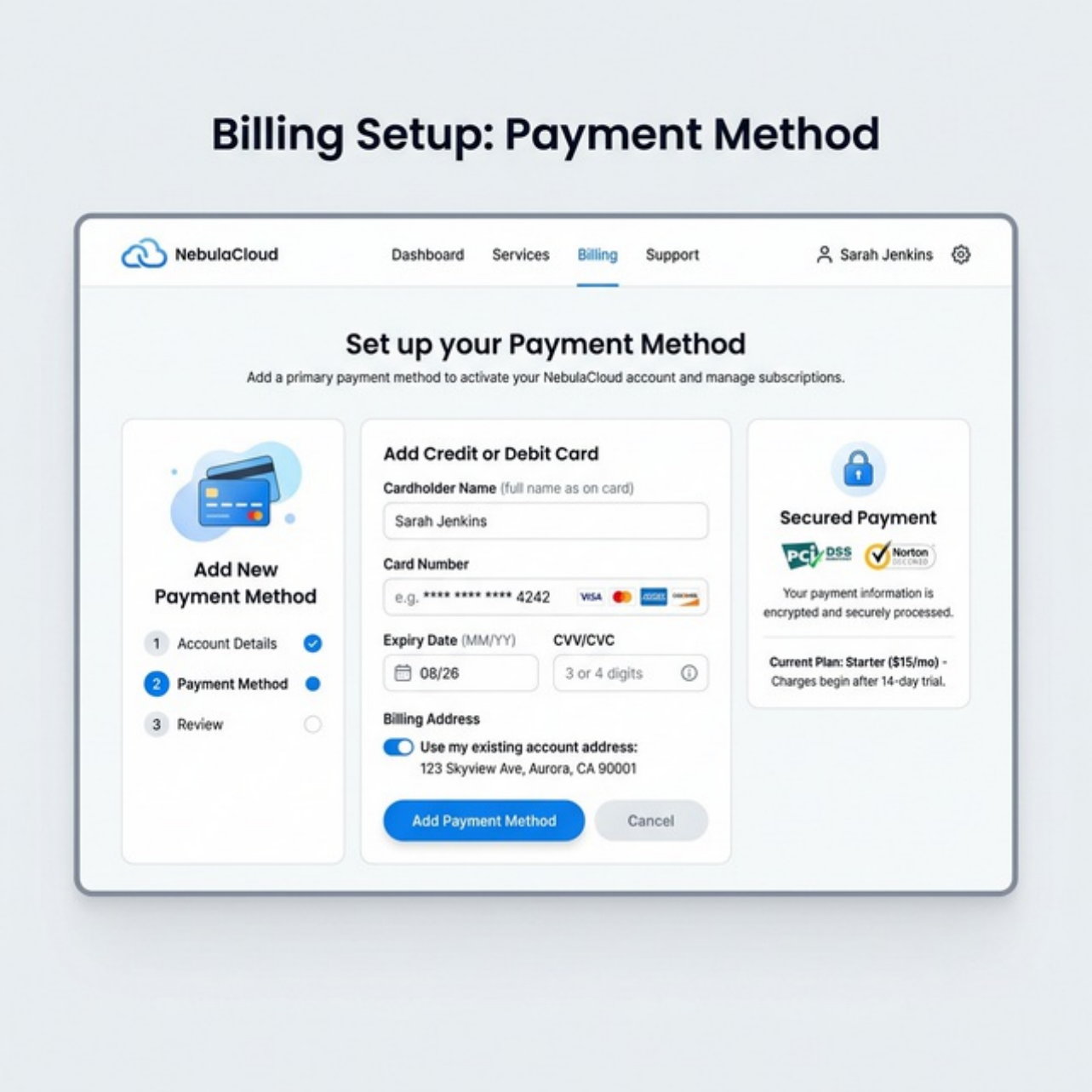
> [!CAUTION]
> **CRITICAL REQUIREMENT: ADDING A PAYMENT METHOD**
> Even though Google Gemini offers a free tier, **you must attach a valid payment method (credit card) to your Google Cloud / Google AI Studio account.** If you do not add a billing method, the AI will frequently crash due to strict rate-limits or quota errors when the platform runs automated tasks. You will only be charged if your usage exceeds the generous free tier limits, but having the card on file is mandatory for production stability.

**How to get your Gemini API Key:**

1. Go to [Google AI Studio (https://aistudio.google.com/)](https://aistudio.google.com/).
2. Sign in with your main Google Account.
3. On the left sidebar, click on **Get API key**.
4. Click on **Create API key** (you can create it in a new or existing project).
5. Copy the generated API key. You will need to save this as GEMINI_API_KEY.




**Set up Billing:**
Go to the [Google Cloud Console Billing Page (https://console.cloud.google.com/billing)](https://console.cloud.google.com/billing), select the project where you created the API key, and link a payment method.




---

## 2. Google / Gmail Integration (For Email Automation)

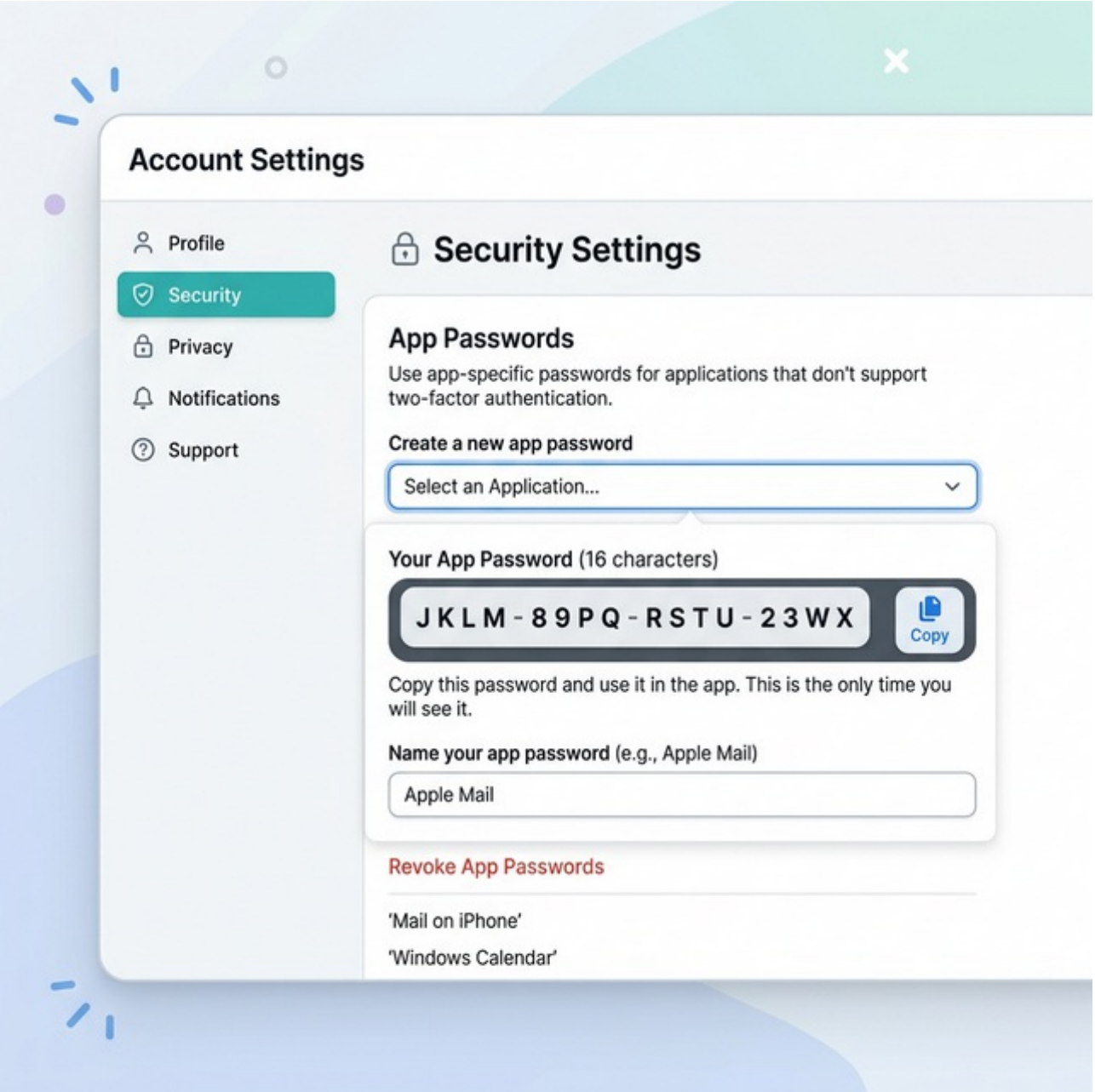
To allow the platform to send and manage emails on your behalf, you need to configure your Google account credentials.

### App Passwords (Simpler & Recommended)

This is the fastest method to allow the platform to send automated emails using your Gmail address.

1. Go to your Google Account management page: [myaccount.google.com (https://myaccount.google.com/)](https://myaccount.google.com/).
2. Navigate to **Security** on the left menu.
3. Under "How you sign in to Google", ensure **2-Step Verification** is turned **ON**.
4. Search for "**App Passwords**" in the top settings search bar.
5. Generate a new App Password. Under the app dropdown, select "Mail", and for device select

"Other (Custom name)" and type "Automation Platform".
6. Google will give you a 16-character password.
7. Save your email address as GMAIL_USER and the 16-character password as GMAIL_APP_PASSWORD (without spaces).




---

## 3. Supabase (Cloud Storage for Assets)

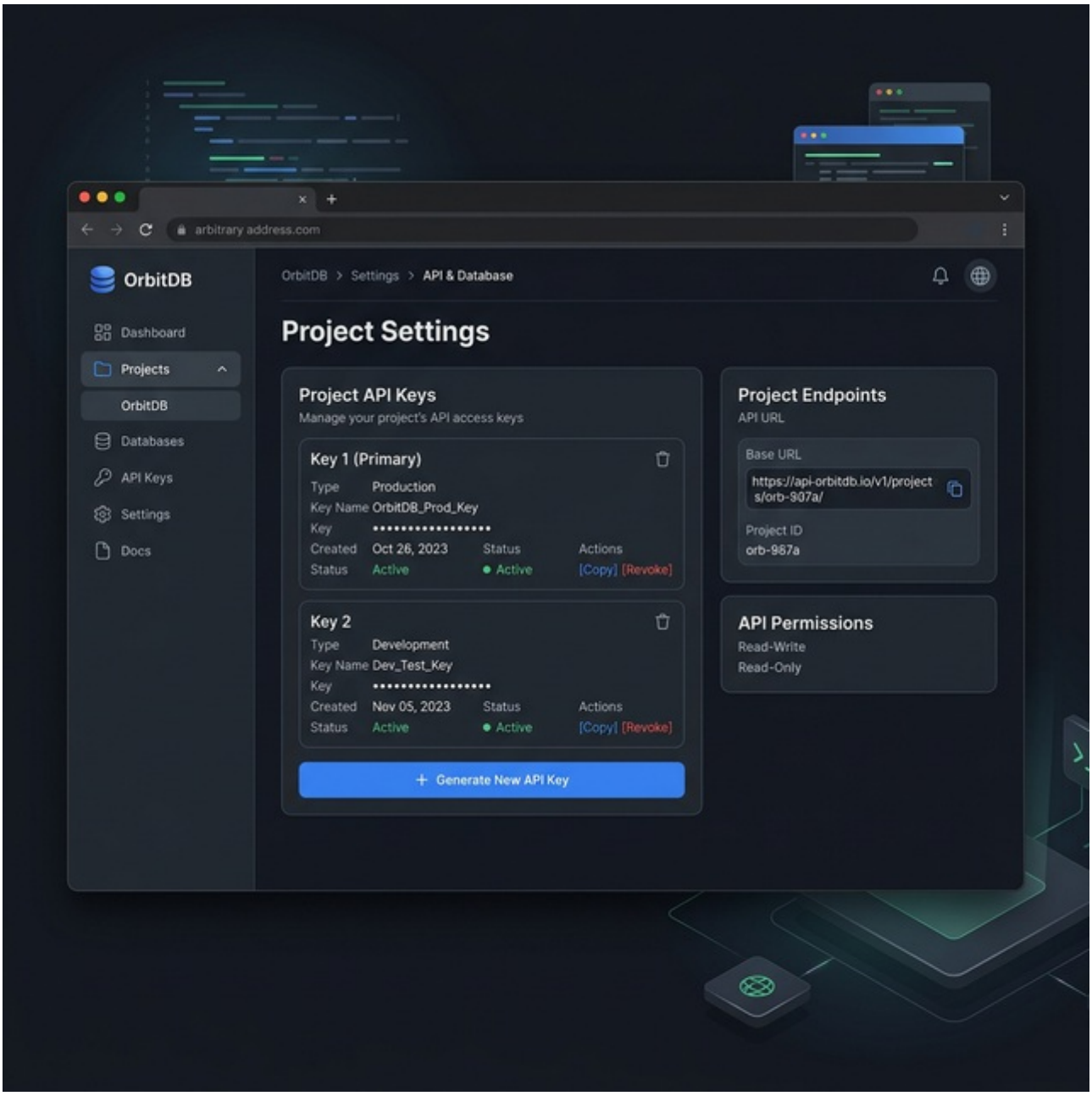
The platform can use cloud storage to safely keep generated assets (images, videos).

**How to get your Supabase Credentials:**

1. Go to [Supabase (https://supabase.com/)](https://supabase.com/) and create a free account.
2. Create a new project.
3. Once the project is ready, go to **Project Settings** (the gear icon on the left sidebar).
4. Click on **API**.
5. Copy the **Project URL** (save as SUPABASE_URL) and the **Project API Key (anon/public)** (save

as SUPABASE_KEY).

6. Next, go to **Storage** from the main dashboard menu.
7. Click **New Bucket**, name it content-assets, and ensure the bucket is configured as **Public**.
8. Save the bucket name as SUPABASE_BUCKET.




## 4. Platform Security & Database Setup

**Internal API Secret:**
Generate a random, secure string (you can use any password generator to create a 32-character mixed-case string).

- Save this as API_SECRET_KEY.

**Database URL:**
You need a cloud PostgreSQL database to store platform data. You can easily get one for free via Supabase, Neon, or Render.

- Save your connection string as DATABASE_URL.

---

## 5. Final Configuration Step: The .env File

Once you have gathered all the credentials above, they need to be placed inside an Environment (.env) file to plug them into the platform. It should look perfectly like this:

```
# Minimum Required Application Secrets
API_SECRET_KEY="your_secure_random_string"
DATABASE_URL="postgresql://user:password@host:5432/dbname"

# AI Content Config
GEMINI_API_KEY="your_gemini_api_key_here"

# Email Automation Config (App Passwords)
GMAIL_USER="your-email@gmail.com"
GMAIL_APP_PASSWORD="your_16_character_app_password"

# Storage Config (If using Supabase)
STORAGE_PROVIDER="supabase"
SUPABASE_URL="your_supabase_url"
SUPABASE_KEY="your_supabase_key"
SUPABASE_BUCKET="content-assets"
```

Once this file is set, the platform is ready to be launched!